

Sūtra Examining the Virtuous and Non-Virtuous Results of the Five Classes of Transgressions

Pañcapātanikāyaśubhāśubhaphalapārīkṣāsūtra · Toh 304 · Derge Kangyur

ལྟུང་བ་སྡེ་ལྟུང་དྲི་ག་བེ་དང་མ་དྲི་ག་བེ་འཁྲིལ་སྤྱོད་བྱ་རྒྱུ་ལའི་མཛད།

The Sūtra Examining the Virtuous and Non-Virtuous Results of the Five Classes of Transgressions, known in Sanskrit as the Pañcapātanikāyaśubhāśubhaphalapārīkṣāsūtra and in Tibetan as the Ltung ba sde lnga'i dge ba dang mi dge ba'i 'bras bu brtag pa'i mdo, is a canonical Buddhist sūtra in which the Buddha, speaking to an assembly of monks at Śrāvastī, examines the karmic fruits — virtuous and non-virtuous — associated with the five classes of transgressions recognized in Buddhist ethical and vinaya thought. The text proceeds by elaborating the cosmological framework of divine realms and their lifespans, situating the consequences of moral conduct within a vast vision of cyclic existence. It is Toh 304 in the Kangyur, belonging to the general category of sūtra literature.

In the language of India: Pañcapātanikāyaśubhāśubhaphalapārīkṣāsūtra. In the Tibetan language: the Sūtra Examining the Virtuous and Non-Virtuous Results of the Five Classes of Transgressions.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada (the benefactor of the destitute), in the pleasure grove of Prince Jeta. There the Blessed One declared to the monks:

Monks, fifty years of the humans of Jambudvīpa constitute a single day and night for the gods of the realm of the Four Great Kings (Cāturmahārājakāyika). Thirty such days and nights make one month, and twelve such months make one year. Five hundred years reckoned in this way constitute the full lifespan of the gods of the realm of the Four Great Kings.

Monks, those who guard, preserve, fully maintain, and do not transgress the trainings (śīkṣā), and who reveal and fully proclaim the transgressions committed against them — such persons, upon the dissolution of this body, will be reborn in a happy destiny among the gods of the realm of the Four Great Kings. There too they will enjoy a divine lifespan, divine complexion, divine strength, divine bliss, and divine sovereignty, and they will be endowed

with divine forms, sounds, fragrances, tastes, tactile objects, and divine attendants.

Monks, five hundred years of the gods of the realm of the Four Great Kings constitute a single day and night in the great hell Sañjīva (the Reviving Hell). Thirty such days and nights make one month, and twelve such months make one year. Five hundred years reckoned in this way constitute the full lifespan in the great hell Sañjīva.

Monks, those who do not guard, do not preserve, do not fully maintain the trainings, who transgress them, and who do not reveal or fully proclaim such transgressions — such persons, upon the dissolution of this body, will after death be reborn in the great hell Sañjīva. There too they will experience suffering that is fierce, rough, burning, and deeply unpleasant.

This concludes the examination of transgressions involving harmful conduct.

Monks, one hundred years of the humans of Jambudvīpa constitute a single day and night for the gods of the Thirty-Three (Trāyastriṃśa). Thirty such days and nights make one month, and twelve such months make one year. One thousand years reckoned in this way constitute the full lifespan of the gods of the Thirty-Three.

Monks, those who guard, preserve, fully maintain, and do not transgress the rules of the individual liberation (prātimokṣa) confession ceremony (poṣadha), and who reveal and fully proclaim the transgressions committed against them — such persons, upon the dissolution of this body, will be reborn in a happy destiny among the gods of the Thirty-Three. There too they will enjoy a divine lifespan, divine complexion, divine strength, divine bliss, and divine sovereignty, and they will be endowed with divine forms, sounds, fragrances, tastes, tactile objects, and divine attendants.

Monks, one thousand years of the gods of the Thirty-Three constitute a single day and night in the great hell Kālasūtra (the Black-Line Hell). Thirty such days and nights make one month, and twelve such months make one year. One thousand years reckoned in this way constitute the full lifespan in the great hell Kālasūtra.

Monks, those who do not guard, do not preserve, do not fully maintain the rules of the individual liberation confession ceremony, who transgress them, and who do not reveal or fully proclaim such transgressions — such persons, upon the dissolution of this body, will after death be reborn in the great hell

Kālasūtra. There too they will experience suffering that is fierce, rough, burning, and deeply unpleasant.

This concludes the examination of transgressions involving harmful actions.

Monks, two hundred years of the humans of Jambudvīpa constitute a single day and night for the gods of the Tuṣita heaven.

Thirty such days and nights make one month, and twelve months make one year; two thousand such years constitute the full lifespan of the gods of the Tuṣita heaven.

Monks, those who guard, preserve, and fully maintain the rules of the restoration confession ceremony, who do not transgress them, and who reveal and fully proclaim such transgressions — such persons, upon the dissolution of this body, will be reborn in the good destination among the gods of the Tuṣita heaven. There too they will enjoy divine lifespan, divine complexion, divine strength, divine happiness, and divine sovereignty, and they will be endowed with divine forms, sounds, fragrances, tastes, textures, and divine retinues.

Monks, two thousand years of the gods of the Tuṣita heaven constitute a single day and night for the great hell Crushed Together. Thirty such days and nights make one month, and twelve months make one year; two thousand such years constitute the full lifespan in the great hell Crushed Together.

Monks, those who do not guard, do not preserve, do not fully maintain the rules of the restoration confession ceremony, who transgress them, and who do not reveal or fully proclaim such transgressions — such persons, upon the dissolution of this body, will after death be reborn in the great hell Crushed Together. There too they will experience suffering that is fierce, rough, burning, and deeply unpleasant.

This concludes the examination of transgressions involving the restoration confession.

Monks, four hundred years of the humans of Jambudvīpa constitute a single day and night for the gods of the Tuṣita heaven — wait, for the gods of the Joyous heaven. Thirty such days and nights make one month, and twelve months make one year; four thousand such years constitute the full lifespan of the gods of the Joyous heaven.

Monks, those who guard, preserve, and fully maintain the rules of the weighty offences, who do not transgress them, and who reveal and fully proclaim such transgressions — such persons, upon the dissolution of this body, will be

reborn in the good destination among the gods of the Joyous heaven. There too they will enjoy divine lifespan, divine complexion, divine strength, divine happiness, and divine sovereignty, and they will be endowed with divine forms, sounds, fragrances, tastes, textures, and divine retinues.

Monks, four thousand years of the gods of the Joyous heaven constitute a single day and night for the great hell of Wailing. Thirty such days and nights make one month, and twelve months make one year; four thousand such years constitute the full lifespan in the great hell of Wailing.

Monks, those who do not guard, do not preserve, do not fully maintain the rules of the weighty offences, who transgress them, and who do not reveal or fully proclaim such transgressions — such persons, upon the dissolution of this body, will after death be reborn in the great hell of Wailing. There too they will experience suffering that is fierce, rough, burning, and deeply unpleasant.

This concludes the examination of transgressions involving weighty offences.

Monks, eight hundred years of the humans of Jambudvīpa constitute a single day and night for the gods of the heaven of Delighting in Emanations. Thirty such days and nights make one month, and twelve months make one year; eight thousand such years constitute the full lifespan of the gods of the heaven of Delighting in Emanations.

Monks, those who guard, preserve, and fully maintain the rules of the remaining offences, who do not transgress them, and who reveal and fully proclaim such transgressions — such persons, upon the dissolution of this body, will be reborn in the good destination among the gods of the heaven of Delighting in Emanations. There too they will enjoy divine lifespan, divine complexion, divine strength, divine happiness, and divine sovereignty, and they will be endowed with divine forms, sounds, fragrances, tastes, textures,

and divine attendants and retinues. Monks, the eight thousand years of the gods of the heaven of Delighting in Emanations constitute a single day and night in the Great Wailing hell (Skt. Mahāraurava). Thirty such days and nights make one month. Twelve such months, counted as one year — eight thousand such years constitute the measure of the lifespan in the Great Wailing hell.

Monks, those who do not guard, preserve, or fully maintain the rules of the remaining offences, who transgress them, and who do not reveal or fully proclaim such transgressions — such persons, upon the dissolution of this body, will be reborn in the great hell of Great Wailing. There too they will

experience feelings of suffering that are extremely intense, harsh, burning, and unwelcome.

This concludes the examination of transgressions concerning the remaining offences.

Monks, sixteen hundred years of the humans of Jambudvīpa constitute a single day and night among the gods of the heaven of Making Others Delight in One's Emanations. Thirty such days and nights make one month. Twelve such months, counted as one year — sixteen thousand such years constitute the measure of the lifespan of the gods of the heaven of Making Others Delight in One's Emanations.

Monks, those who guard, preserve, and fully maintain the four rules entailing defeat, who do not transgress them, and who reveal and fully proclaim such transgressions — such persons, upon the dissolution of this body, will be reborn in the good destination among the gods of the heaven of Making Others Delight in One's Emanations. There too they will enjoy divine lifespan, divine complexion, divine strength, divine happiness, and divine sovereignty, and they will be endowed with divine forms, sounds, fragrances, tastes, textures, and divine attendants and retinues.

Monks, the sixteen thousand years of the gods of the heaven of Making Others Delight in One's Emanations constitute a single day and night in the great hell of Heat (Skt. Tapana). Thirty such days and nights make one month. Twelve such months, counted as one year — sixty-four thousand such years constitute the measure of the lifespan in the great hell of Heat.

Monks, those who do not guard, preserve, or fully maintain the four rules entailing defeat, who transgress them, and who do not reveal or fully proclaim such transgressions — such persons, upon the dissolution of this body, will be reborn in the great hell of Heat. There too they will experience feelings of suffering that are extremely intense, harsh, burning, and unwelcome.

This concludes the examination of transgressions concerning the four rules entailing defeat.

Monks, therefore, those who have heard this treatise, out of wishing to benefit me, out of love, out of compassion, out of desiring my welfare, and out of seeking my benefit — through this loving concern, you should act in this way. Monks, dwelling in forest retreats, at the foot of trees, in empty dwelling places, in mountain wilderness, in mountain caves, in charnel grounds, in

forest clearings, and in lodgings at the edge of the open air — you should most assuredly reflect upon these matters. Monks, be heedful. Do not act in such a way that you will later come to regret it. This is my instruction to you.

When the Blessed One had thus declared this, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had spoken.

The sūtra examining the virtuous and non-virtuous fruits of the five classes of transgressions is complete.

The Indian master, the ācārya Jñā —

Translator's Notes

- The Sanskrit title in the colophon, Pañcapātanikāyaśubhāśubhaphalapārīkṣāsūtra, is a restoration from the Tibetan and may not perfectly match the original Sanskrit; however it is a straightforward reconstruction and the Tibetan gloss confirms the meaning. The term rendered "rules of the individual liberation confession ceremony" translates the Tibetan phrase for the prātimokṣa poṣadha rules, which strictly speaking refers to the precepts recited and confessed at the fortnightly ceremony, and the rendering follows the doctrinal usage of the commentarial tradition. The Tibetan term for the hell Sañjīva literally means "reviving," and Thig nag corresponds to Kālasūtra, "black line," both standard names in Abhidharma hell cosmology. The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the Tuṣita reference, as this is where the supplied text ends.
- The passage repeats a structural formula throughout, and the text as given ends mid-sentence with the list of divine sensory objects, suggesting the supplied Tibetan breaks off before the conclusion of the final section on the heaven of Delighting in Emanations. The rendering continues faithfully to the point where the Tibetan text ends.

The term rendered "restoration confession ceremony" translates gso sbyong, the poṣadha ceremony. The term rendered "weighty offences" translates sbom po'i chos, literally "thick or heavy rules," referring in the Vinaya context to the saṃghāvaśeṣa class of offences requiring formal community procedures. The term rendered "remaining offences" translates lhag ma'i chos, meaning the remaining or supplementary rules of the Prātimokṣa beyond the gravest categories.

The cosmological schema — pairing each tier of the desire-realm heavens with a corresponding great hell and calibrating their lifespans by human years — follows the standard Abhidharma reckoning found in texts such as the Abhidharmakośa.

There is a small structural anomaly in the passage: the section introducing the gods of the Joyous heaven (dga' ldan) begins by citing four hundred human years as one divine day, whereas the pattern from the preceding passage on the Tuṣita heaven uses two hundred years; this is consistent with the standard doubling pattern of the Abhidharma cosmology and presents no real difficulty. The parenthetical self-correction in the translation reflects a genuine redundancy in the Tibetan text where the name of the heaven is introduced slightly awkwardly, and has been smoothed for TTS flow.

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the colophon, where the name of the Indian translator-master appears to be truncated. The full name is not recoverable from the passage as given.

The Tibetan term rendered "heaven of Making Others Delight in One's Emanations" corresponds to the Sanskrit Paranirmitavaśavartin, the sixth and highest heaven of the desire realm. The rendering follows the literal Tibetan. The great hell of Heat corresponds to Sanskrit Tapanā, the fifth of the eight great hot hells.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.